grace
COMMUNITY CHURCH

BRAND GUIDELINE

grace

COMMUNITY CHURCH

THIS BOOK IS ABOUT OUR BRAND

A brand is not a logo or the visuals; those are expressions of the brand—the brand's identity. A brand is an intangible idea that exists in the minds of people. When you hear Disney, the first thing you think of is what the Disney brand means to you. In other words, Disney can't own their brand; they can only shape it.

For any organization, a brand is mostly about the DNA and story of the company: what defines you, who you are, what you do, and why it matters.

In this document, we define the core elements of our story. Rather than seeking to explain our entire history, we boil it down to the most vital parts; we define today while honoring yesterday.

The following pages provide guidance and direction for how to manage the look and feel of our logo and brand identity. Use this book carefully and consistently to ensure people build connections between the brand identity and the church it represents.



OUR BRAND STORY

We are the only community church in the DMV area that compassionately welcomes challenge with people searching for more so that Jesus is seen clearly through us.

We are diverse welcomers, partners, volunteers, and servant leaders who overcome whatever gets in the way of a vibrant community of people from all kinds of backgrounds, beliefs, and walks of life.

We courageously articulate the Gospel with clarity, love, and truth, with the goal of building relationships and help people find what they have been missing.

We offer humble environments that focus on Christ, community, and compassion. You belong! We measure success through baptisms, stories, participation, team involvement, groups, and engagement.

We listen, accepting people and changing their misconceptions about who God is. No one goes alone.

We are unexpected as church happens here. With countless stories of changed lives for nearly 20 years and counting, we see more out of life for everyone.

Grace Community Church
A church for people who don't go to church



STRATEGIC IDENTITY

Every brand has a unique way it expresses and carries itself. Apple communicates and feels different than Hewlett Packard, even though they're functionally the same type of business—this distinction is due to their unique identities.

The identity is formed through the combination of five attributes, each adding to the psychological makeup of the brand.

We strive to be:

DIVERSE
We are physically diverse. That means our brand is inclusive and multi-cultural.

COURAGEOUS
We are emotionally courageous. That means our brand is daring and faith-filled.

HUMBLE
We are intellectually humble. That means our brand is genuine and authentic.

ACCEPTING
We are socially accepting. That means relationally our brand is inviting and non-judemental.

UNEXPECTED
We are spiritually unexpected. That means at the core of who we are, we are unconventional and surprising.



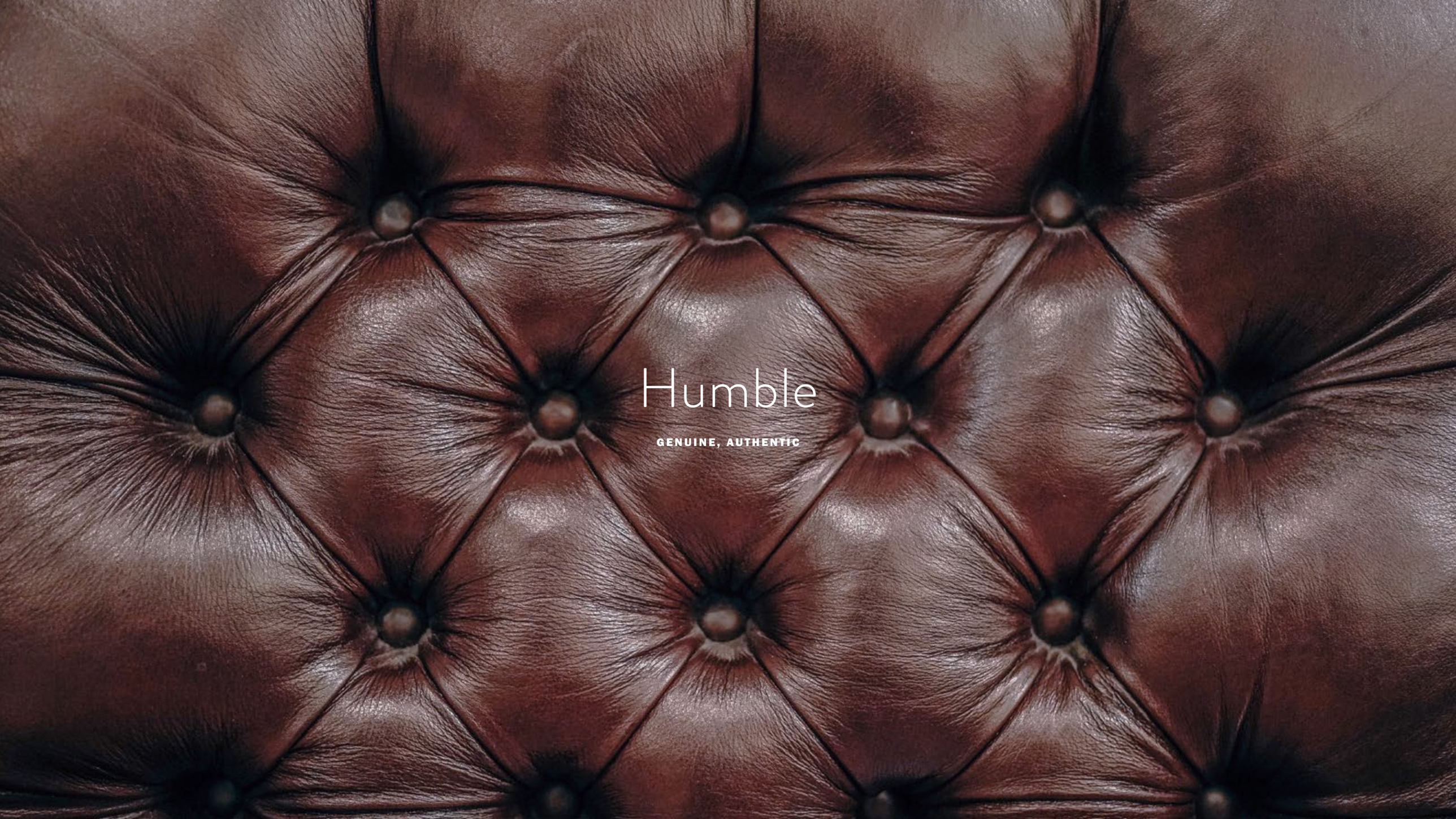
Diverse

INCLUSIVE, MULTI-CULTURAL



Courageous

DARING, FAITH-FILLED


Humble
GENUINE, AUTHENTIC



Accepting

INVITING, NON-JUDGMENTAL



Unexpected

UNCONVENTIONAL, SURPRISING

grace
COMMUNITY CHURCH

OUR LOGO

Our newly revised logo is a modernization of our previous mark. It uses our full church name and is also available in a secondary icon format.

Our logo is a simple reflection of our church. We seek to make grace apparent—to get ourselves out of the way and keep the Gospel clear.

The style of our logo is modern and geometric, it is a wordmark composed with a monowidth stroke and intentional spacing. Community Church is highlighted with our brand color, it is sized and positioned to maximize legibility.

OUR LOGO

01 Our primary logo features our full church name and has been designed in a horizontal format. Use this for the majority of Grace Community Church communications and publications—especially anything that is official or externally promotional.

01



02 The icon version of the logo may be used in instances where brand familiarity is already established (i.e., communications to members, events on campus etc.). It may be used for external communications, in situations where space becomes an issue and requires a more compact expression of our identity. It may also be used in communications where the full logo is also used within the same material (i.e., the front of a postcard when the back features the logo with our full name).

The icon can be used in active blue with a reversed white g, in white with a knocked out g, or in white with a black g depending on background complexity and contrast.

02



MINISTRY LOGOS

Our church ministries follow along the new identity system by adopting the icon in combination with a wordmark that prioritizes the ministry name over the church. The text should always be horizontally aligned centered to the icon.

A wordmark only version has also been created, this version can be used interchangeably.









KIDS

A greater visual variation from other ministries has been created for Kids ministry. A distinct typeface has replaced the word ‘Kids’ in addition to a hand-drawn outlined circle that surrounds the ‘G’.

This variation allows the brand to appropriately shift in tone for this important ministry segment and at the same time supports brand consistency.







YOUTH

Like Kids Ministry, Youth was also designed to carry a greater level of flexibility. Flexibility held only for their use.

The Youth Ministry can leverage textures and photography as a filler for the circle that surrounds the “g” icon.

These photos can use brand colors or colors that are complementary to our brand colors. The most important thing to keep in mind when applying a photograph or texture is to maintain enough contrast with the “g” icon.



LOGO APPLICATION

01 The logo can be used in two color version should only be used when the background (solid color or photographic) that holds contrast against the Active Blue.

02 When the logo is used with Active Blue or on a background that does not supply enough contrast to use the two color version, it should be reversed out to white. This creates the appropriate contrast and harmony for t he look and feel of our brand.

03 While a color logo application is preferred, a full black and white logo may be used when color is unavailable. Grayscale should not be used to distinguish different elements of the logo.

01





02





03





MINIMUM SIZE

01 To ensure the image is visually dynamic and to avoid poor visual representation, reproduction of the full name version of the logo, can be no smaller than 1.5 inches when printed, and no smaller than 144 pixels when used on screen.

02 To ensure the image is visually dynamic and to avoid poor visual representation, reproduction of the icon may be no smaller than 0.25 inches when printed, and no smaller than 24 pixels when used on screen.

01



Actual minimum length:
1.5 inches / 144 pixels

02



Actual minimum length:
0.25 inches / 24 pixels

CLEAR SPACE

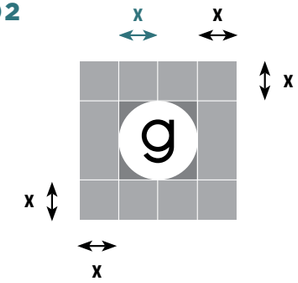
01 The full name version of our logo should always be surrounded by a minimum area of space: equal to or greater than the width of the G within the Grace wordmark. This area of isolation ensures that headlines, text or other visual elements do not encroach on the logo.

02 The icon version of our logo should always be surrounded by a minimum area of space: equal to or greater than half the width of the full icon text. This area of isolation ensures that headlines, text or other visual elements do not encroach on the logo.

01



02



LOGO RESTRICTIONS

01 Do not put the logo in a tight box. Give it room to “breathe.” Placing the logo in a box is acceptable as long as the clear space rules still apply.

02 Do not distort or skew the logo.

03 Do not fill the logo with a gradient.

04 Do not add an outline/stroke to the logo.

05 Don’t change size relationship between the arrow icon and logo type.

06 Do not stretch the logo taller or wider; keep it proportional.

01



02



03



04



05



06



COLOR

Active Blue is the foundation of our brand's color palette. It embodies our accepting and unexpected brand characteristic and creates a refreshing baseline for our brand's expression.

We pair and accent Active Blue with Stable Blue. A darker blue both compliments and contrasts with the lighter blue to create a sense of stability and presence, helping to embody our humble brand characteristic.

We balance out our brand's color palette, through the use of Cinder Gray and Cloud Gray. These neutral tones are used to diffuse contrast and prevent one color from becoming too dominant.

A strong identifying mark of our brand is when our brand colors are used together and balanced well. To help maintain proper balance, the colors and the amount in which they are used is indicated by the length of the color bar.

Active Blue
C77 / M23 / Y36 / K1
R47 / G151 / B160
#2F97A0
PANTONE 2235 C

Stable Blue
C100 / M85 / Y31 / K18
R28 / G59 / B107
#1C3B6B
PANTONE 534 C

Cinder Gray
C34 / M27 / Y28 / K0
R171 / G171 / B171
#ABABAB
PANTONE 429 C

Cloud Gray
C10 / M7 / Y7 / K0
R227 / G227 / B227
#E3E3E3
PANTONE 427 C

TYPEFACE

Our brand identity utilizes three typefaces.

Brandon Grotesque is a heavy and modern sans-serif typeface that boasts sharp letterforms that a rebalanced with subtle round endcaps. Both the black and light weight can be used as headers. This interchangeability allows our brand to have a great deal of design flexibility.

For punchy subheaders, Franklin Gothic Heavy has been selected. It's shorter X-height creates a dense and stubby appearance that is legible even at smaller sizes.

Lato regular is designed by Google and is best served as body copy. It's clean and geometric design supports readability. It is a no fuss typeface that pairs well with the other modern fonts within our brand system.

BRANDON GROSTEQUE BLACK

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ1234567890

FRANKLIN GOTHIC HEAVY

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ1234567890

LATO REGULAR

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ1234567890

TYPE HIERARCHY

This hierarchy refers to the order of importance of the fonts and proportional scale of each as they relate to one another. Note: The point sizes are set for 8.5 x 11” printed materials. These point sizes are provided as a sample to showcase the appropriate proportions.

Sample Hierarchy

01 Header
Font Size: 47pt
Font Weight: Light
Leading: N/A
Tracking: 0

02 Sub Header
Font Size: 15pt
Font Weight: Heavy
Leading: N/A
Tracking: 160

03 Pull-Quote
Font Size: 11pt
Font Weight: Black
Leading: 15pt
Tracking: 140

04 Body Copy
Font Size: 10pt
Font Weight: Regular
Leading: 13pt
Tracking: 0

01 Main Header

02 SUB-HEADER

03 “PULL QUOTES CAN BE CREATED WITH LATO BLACK WEIGHT”

04 Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetuer adipiscing elit, sed diam nonummy nibh euismod tincidunt ut laoreet dolore magna aliquam erat volutpat. Duis autem vel eum iriure dolor in hendrerit in vulputate velit esse molestie.

GRAPHICS & APPLICATION

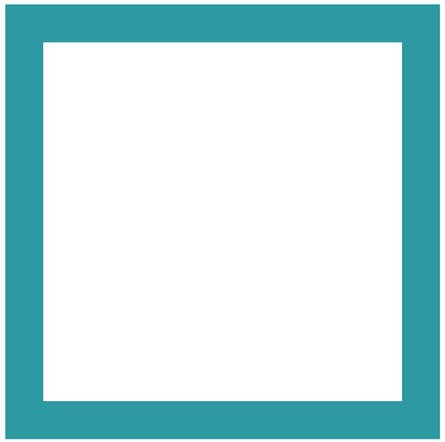
Our brand system includes a gradient that blends our brand's blue colors. The use of a gradient adds depth to the design, it should be used when you need to create something to grab attention. However, use of the gradient may cause color pairing difficulties when used alongside colored photography. Photography should be edited to black and white to help establish a nice pairing, when using the gradient. The same approach is used when typography is applied on top of the gradient. White type creates the best contrast, other colors should be avoided.

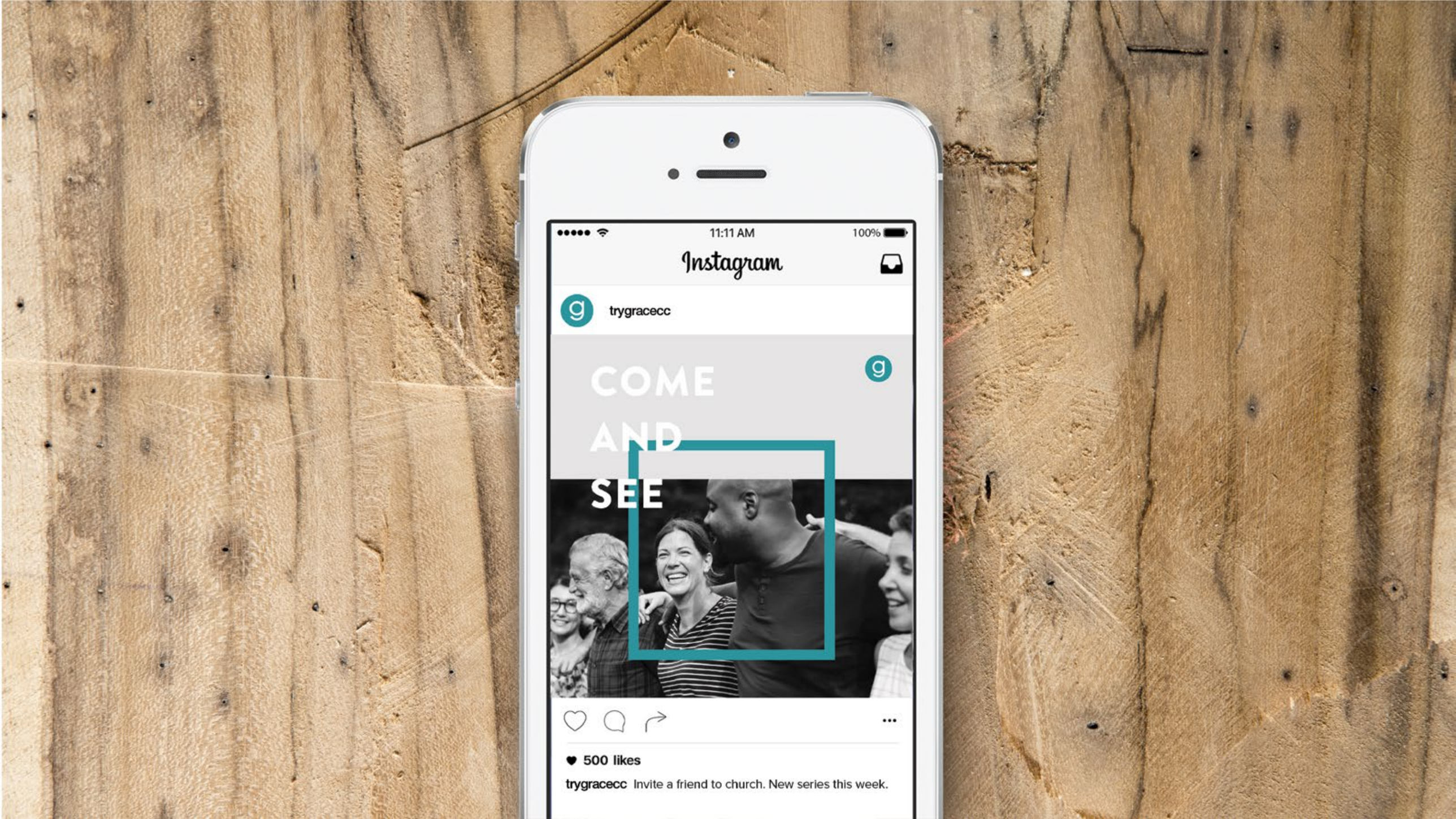
Never utilize a portion of the gradient. The full range of color should always be displayed. In order to accomplish this, the gradient file should be scaled or adjusted to fit.

A frame has been designed to further add depth to design work. Depth is created when the frame is superimposed with the subject of the photography; cutting the frame makes it appear as though it is going behind the subject, this builds interest and makes the work unique to our system. The framing tool can also help draw attention to key text.

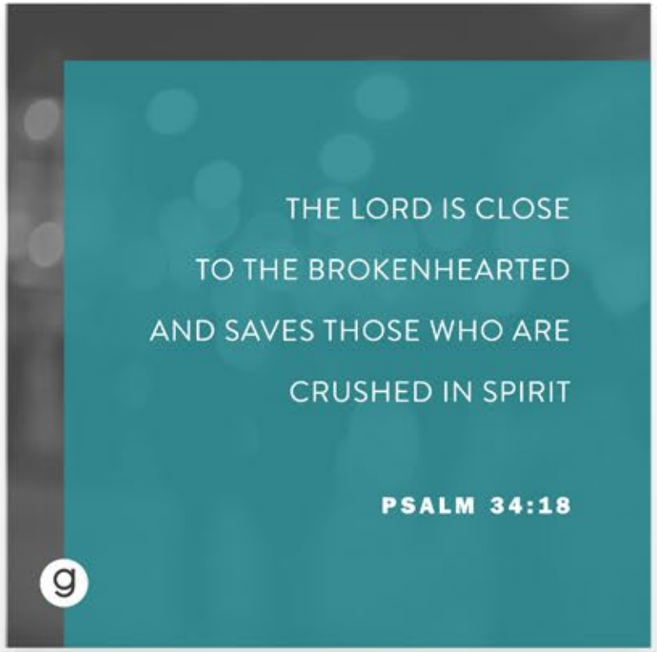
The following pages highlight the use of the gradient, the frame, as well as photography that fits our brand system. Photography that carries our brand colors helps keep the system recognizable. Warmer colors, found in skin tones for example, prevent the work from becoming overly cold.






11:11 AM
100%
Instagram
trygracecc
COME
AND
SEE
500 likes
trygracecc Invite a friend to church. New series this week.


WOMENS
RETREAT


THE LORD IS CLOSE
TO THE BROKENHEARTED
AND SAVES THOSE WHO ARE
CRUSHED IN SPIRIT
PSALM 34:18


Worship
Night
WEDNESDAY | 7:00PM


I'M OUT
TO CHANGE
MY WORLD
grace


A PLACE
TO BELONG
BEFORE YOU BELIEVE
grace


grace
Winter
Coat Drive
ALL SIZES AND STYLES ARE NEEDED.

grace
COMMUNITY CHURCH

John Slye, Jr.
LEAD PASTOR

JOHN.SLYE@TRYGRACE.ORG

O: 012.345.6789 | C: 012.345.6789

5401 7TH ROAD SOUTH, ARLINGTON VA, 22204

GRACE COMMUNITY CHURCH
5401 7th Road South,
Arlington, VA 22204

PLAINJOE STUDIOS
7345 Piute Creek Dr. Corona, CA 92881

Giving

grace
COMMUNITY CHURCH

grace
COMMUNITY CHURCH

5401 7TH ROAD SOUTH, ARLINGTON VA, 22204
012.345.6788 | 012.345.6789
WWW.TRYGRACE.ORG

THE ARGUMENT AGAINST FILLER TEXT

If you're thinking that filler text seems pretty boring and uncontroversial, you'd be wrong.

Surprisingly, there is a very vocal faction of the design community that wants to see filler text banished to the original sources from whence it came. Perhaps not surprisingly, in an era of endless quibbling, there is an equally vocal contingent of designers leaping to defend the use of the time-honored tradition of greeking.

The argument in favor of using filler text goes something like this: If you use real content in the design process, anytime you reach a review point you'll end up reviewing and negotiating the content itself and not the design. This will just slow down the design process. Design first, with real content in mind (of course!), but don't drop in the real content until the design is well on its way. Using filler text avoids the inevitable argumentation that accompanies the use of real content in the design process.

Those opposed to using filler text of any sort counter by saying: The ultimate purpose of any digital product, whether a website, app, or HTML email, is to showcase real content, not to showcase great design. You can't get a true sense for how your content plays with your design unless you use the real thing!

LET'S JUST AGREE TO DISAGREE

Before things get too heated, let us jump in and say that both sides make valid points.

Using real content during design can distract designers and design review teams alike away from the design, and insisting on always using publication-ready content can be a real drag on the design process.

On the other hand, if you use poorly formatted filler text you may get a completely false sense of how your design will interact with real content.

We propose a compromise: Only use filler text that has been edited for length and format to match the characteristics of real content as closely as possible, and use real content where possible, and where it doesn't create too much distraction.

Relax and do whatever fits with your design process. Don't set a lot of restrictive hard-and-fast rules.

Name
POSITION



Business Card


grace
COMMUNITY CHURCH




P
GUEST
PARKING
grace
COMMUNITY CHURCH


g
Auditorium
Guest Services
Restrooms



Make friends & experience God

You've just discovered the best youth group in Northen Virginia! Students today are overwhelmed by everything around them competing for their attention. Through it all the core questions of life seem to remain unanswered-Who am I? Why am I alive? The youth team works hard to create environments that allow students to be themselves, have fun, and explore the deep questions of life at their own pace. Try out one of our environments and start getting more out of life!



9:30 AM Thomas Jefferson Middle School | **11:00 AM** George Mason High School







Grace Women,Nextstep, Grace in 5

FOR MORE INFORMATION:

Please contact Heather Noble: heather.noble@trygrace.org

TRYGRACE.ORG